James Clarke

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EDUCATION

San Diego State University *San Diego, CA*
Bachelor of Science, BS *Expected May 2029*
Major: *Computer Science* Minor: *Mathematics*
Relevant Coursework: *CS470 UNIX System Administration*

EXPERIENCE

Invitational Collegiate Cyber Defense Competition *San Diego, CA*
Systems Operations / Blue Team Support *Oct. 2025, Oct. 2026*
• Maintained Linux systems and services during simulated red team attacks while monitoring for suspicious activity
• Analyzed system and network logs to identify indicators of compromise and investigate potential attack vectors
• Conducted network reconnaissance using Nmap to identify exposed services and support system hardening

SDSU Cyber Defense Team *San Diego, CA*
Deputy System Administrator *April 2026 - Present*
• Manage a multi-OS virtualized infrastructure supporting club activities, Wireguard VPN, Windows Server, DNS/PKI, Ubuntu, AlmaLinux, FreeBSD, and containerized systems.
• Monitored and deployed VMs and services running Proxmox, Terraform, Ansible, Packer, Forgejo, CI/CD runners, Docker, and LXC containers.
• Built and configured competition VMs while interpreting system administrator playbooks to build a practice Collegiate Cyber Defense Competition environment.

SDSU Infrastructure Lab *San Diego, CA*
System Administrator *Jan. 2026 - May 2026*
• Built a multi-OS lab with DNS, LDAP, PKI, SMTP/IMAP, NFS, nginx/Docker, and centralized logging
• Configured UNIX/Linux servers for authentication, mail, file sharing, web hosting, containers, and remote access
• Deployed a multi-node Kubernetes cluster with fault-tolerant web services and automated failover

San Diego Yacht Club *San Diego, CA*
Deploying Employee Security Systems *Sept. 2026 - Present*
• Conducted a cybersecurity risk assessment of the SDYC staff technology practices, systems, workflows, training, and security controls to evaluate confidentiality, integrity, availability, and overall security posture.
• Reviewed access controls, least-privilege practices, and security frameworks to identify risks.
• Collaborated with a team to document observations and develop recommendations to improve the SDYC's security posture.

SKILLS

Networking & Infrastructure: DNS, LDAP, SMTP, IMAP, NFS, SSH, VPNs, PKI, Git, GitHub, nginx
Security & Log Analysis: Wireshark, tcpdump, Nmap
Systems & Cloud: Azure, Docker, Proxmox, Linux, UNIX administration, UTM, Kubernetes
Operating Systems: OpenBSD, FreeBSD, AlmaLinux, Ubuntu, Solaris, AIX, Windows, macOS
Scripting: Python, C++, Java, Bash

CERTIFICATIONS

CompTIA Security+ *Expected December 2026*
Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate
National Cyber League Fall 2025 Team Game & Individual Game